

Five Friendly Open Source Tools for Testing Web Applications

Web application testing helps ensure that the apps conform to certain set standards. It is a means to check for any bugs in the application before the latter goes live or the code is released on the Internet. Various aspects of the application and its behaviour under different conditions are checked. Here's a brief introduction to five popular open source tools you can use for this job.



The term 'Web application' or 'Web app' is often confused with 'website'. So let's get that doubt cleared —a Web application is a computer app that is hosted on a website. A website has some fixed content while a Web application performs various definite actions based on the users' inputs and actions.

Web application testing

Web application testing involves all those activities that software testers perform to certify a Web app. This testing has its own set of criteria and checkpoints, based on the development model, to decide whether the actions are part of expected behaviour or not.

Types of testing

1. **Functional testing:** Functional testing is a superset validating all those features and functionalities that the application is meant to perform. It includes testing the business logic around the set rules. Listed below are some of the common checkpoints:
 - Tests links to a page from external pages.
 - Validates the response to a form submission.
 - Checks, creates, reads, updates, deletes (CRUD) tasks.
 - Verifies that the data retrieved is correct.
 - Identifies database connectivity and query errors.
2. **Browser compatibility testing:** Because of the availability of cross-platform browser versions, it